

PROJECT REPORT

Digital Literacy

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INTRODUCTION

The Digital Literacy Project (CSE0001) at VIT Bhopal is designed to equip first-year B.Tech students with essential skills for navigating the digital world responsibly and professionally. In this scenario, students take on the role of a Student Digital Ambassador, guiding peers in building online portfolios, practicing safe communication, and understanding cybercrime awareness. The project is structured into five tasks: creating an infographic on digital literacy, setting up professional profiles on platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn, exploring coding and collaboration tools, drafting professional emails with etiquette guidelines, and researching cybercrime case studies with prevention strategies. All tasks are compiled into a GitHub repository with a README and a detailed project report. This initiative emphasizes practical application, reflection, and responsible digital behaviour, ensuring students develop a strong foundation for academic and professional growth.

Task 1:

I chose safe internet practices, email etiquette, and cybercrime awareness because they are the most common areas where students face challenges. While creating the infographic, I learned how visual design can make information easier to understand and remember. Using Canva helped me organize ideas clearly with icons and colours. This task showed me that digital literacy is not just about technical skills but also about responsible communication and safety online. By combining text with icons and colours, the information became more engaging and memorable compared to plain notes. At the same time, I found it slightly difficult to balance simplicity with detail — I had to carefully choose which points to include so the design stayed clear without overwhelming the viewer. Overall, this task taught me that effective communication in digital literacy is not just about the content, but also about how it is presented visually.

Task 2:

Over the next four years, I plan to actively use three platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. GitHub is primarily a platform for hosting and sharing code. It allows me to collaborate on projects, track changes, and build a portfolio of my programming work. I will use GitHub to showcase assignments, personal projects, and open-source contributions, which will demonstrate my technical growth to potential employers.

LinkedIn is a professional networking site where I can connect with peers, professors, and industry professionals. It serves as a digital resume, highlighting my skills, achievements, and experiences. Over time, I will use LinkedIn to expand my network, follow companies of interest, and apply for internships and job opportunities.

Kaggle is a platform focused on data science and machine learning. It provides datasets, competitions, and a community of learners. I plan to use Kaggle to practice data analysis, participate in challenges, and learn from shared notebooks. This will help me strengthen my analytical skills and gain practical exposure.

Together, these platforms will form a strong digital portfolio that reflects my academic progress, professional growth, and technical expertise throughout my degree.

Task 3:

For Task 3, I used two platforms: HackerRank and Google Forms. On HackerRank, I practiced a beginner-level coding challenge that required me to write a simple program and test it against multiple inputs. This helped me strengthen my problem-solving skills and gain confidence in applying programming concepts in a structured environment. On Google Forms, I created a short quiz with five questions related to digital literacy. The quiz allowed me to explore how online tools can be used for collaboration, assessment, and sharing knowledge with peers.

These tools will be very useful academically over the next few years. HackerRank provides a practical way to improve coding skills, prepare for technical interviews, and track progress through challenges. Google Forms, on the other hand, is a versatile tool for creating surveys, quizzes, and feedback forms, which can support group projects and presentations. Together, they enhance both my technical and collaborative abilities. By consistently using these platforms, I will be able to improve my programming expertise while also learning how to communicate and evaluate ideas effectively in academic settings.

Task 4:

A common example of poor digital communication causing problems is when a company sends unclear emails about deadlines. Imagine a project team receiving a vague message like, “Submit the report soon.” Without a specific date or time, half the team assumes it’s due by the end of the week, while others think it’s due immediately. As a result, the report is submitted late, frustrating the client and damaging trust. This situation could have been avoided with precise communication: stating the exact deadline, clarifying expectations, and using tools like shared calendars or project management platforms. Clear, concise, and structured digital communication ensures everyone is aligned, prevents misunderstandings, and maintains professional credibility.

Task 5:

While researching digital communication, what surprised me most was how often misunderstandings arise not from technical issues but from human habits—like assuming tone will be understood in text or skipping details because “everyone knows.” I realized that even small lapses, such as not clarifying deadlines or using vague language, can snowball into major problems for teams and relationships. One habit I will personally change is being more intentional with clarity: instead of writing short, rushed messages, I’ll take a moment to specify details, confirm understanding, and choose words carefully. This small adjustment can prevent confusion, save time, and build stronger trust in both academic and professional settings.

CONCLUSION

The overall learning from the Digital Literacy Project (CSE0001) can be summarized as a holistic development of digital skills, responsible online behavior, and professional communication. Through the five structured tasks, students gained practical exposure to creating infographics, building professional portfolios on GitHub and LinkedIn, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, drafting effective emails, and researching cybercrime case studies. These activities fostered technical proficiency, creativity, and awareness of digital ethics.

Key learnings include:

- Understanding the importance of a strong digital presence.
- Practicing clarity and etiquette in online communication.
- Recognizing cyber threats and preventive strategies.
- Applying tools like GitHub, Kaggle, and Google Forms for academic and professional growth.
- Reflecting on responsible digital citizenship.

Overall, the project nurtured confidence, adaptability, and readiness for future academic and career opportunities, making students digitally literate ambassadors in their environment.

Would you like me to also frame this in a marks distribution format (like 20 marks per task) to make it exam-ready?